CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 10

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- a local bus
- a rapid train
- a commuter train
- a long-distance bus

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- She lives outside of town.
- She plans to take the bus more often.
- She rarely travels on public transit.
- She needs many tickets.

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ask for a discount
- visit another store
- return home
- purchase tickets

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- She likes to read.
- She might miss the bus.
- She looks young.
- She made a mistake.

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

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Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- take the woman to the bus stop
- offer the woman a refund
- give the woman the correct tickets
- confirm the woman's age

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- She needs more transit tickets.
- She wants to thank the man.
- She has a new transit problem.
- She is buying something else.

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- plastic bags
- a fabric bag
- her unused tickets
- a school backpack

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ His kids are preparing a Canada Day surprise.
- ◯ He and his family enjoy attending the events.
- ◯ He wants to know what events are happening.
- ◯ His family has just moved to Canada recently.

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ They should include more activities for kids.
- ◯ They are more interesting on TV.
- ◯ They should include more Canadian themes.
- ◯ They take place when it is too hot.

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ watching the entertainment
- ◯ being outside in warm weather
- ◯ seeing the Canadian animals
- ◯ getting free parking downtown

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She asked him for Canada Day suggestions for her kids.
- ◯ He thinks she should take her kids to the Canada Day events.
- ◯ She believes Canada Day events are mainly for adults.
- ◯ He would like their families to celebrate Canada Day together.

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She takes her kids to the parade.
- ◯ She visits a new place each year.
- ◯ She spends the day by the water.
- ◯ She eats downtown with her family.

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ Devo attends his sessions infrequently.
- ◯ Devo is not interested in learning math.
- ◯ Devo finds his tutoring sessions boring.
- ◯ Devo is not learning math very quickly.

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- ◯ once a week
- ◯ twice a week
- ◯ three times a week
- ◯ a few times a week

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ to move Devo to a different day
- ◯ to check available tutoring times
- ◯ to request a lower price for them
- ◯ to get advice about tutoring Devo

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ to improve Devo's math homework habits
- ◯ to ensure Devo gets higher math grades
- ◯ to help Devo's parents monitor his homework
- ◯ to reduce Devo's need for tutoring sessions

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ learning games
- ◯ Devo's father
- ◯ educational songs
- ◯ Devo's math teacher

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ play learning games with Devo
- ◯ give Devo a reward chart
- ◯ have Devo write a test each session
- ◯ create new exercise sheets for Devo

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. The houseboat seems to be attracting attention because of its _____
- ◯ owner.
- ◯ location.
- ◯ design.
- ◯ purpose.

2. Before she built her houseboat, Ms. Moretti had recently _____
- ◯ built a houseboat in London.
- ◯ studied marine biology abroad.
- ◯ obtained a university degree.
- ◯ lived in a nearby apartment.

3. Ms. Moretti is _____
- ◯ unsure of her plans for the future.
- ◯ unable to find work at the moment.
- ◯ planning to travel the world using her boat.
- ◯ trying to find a roommate to move in with her.

4. Mike MacDonald, a neighbourhood resident, likely _____
- ◯ wants to own a houseboat.
- ◯ visits the houseboat regularly.
- ◯ fishes in Clearwater Harbour.
- ◯ wants Ms. Moretti to leave.

5. The news item mainly describes a _____
- ◯ dispute in a neighbourhood.
- ◯ person who built a unique residence.
- ◯ houseboat that has traveled the world.
- ◯ beautiful harbour in a city.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. Why does Grace want to go to school?
- ◯ to finish a program she quit
- ◯ to study her current profession
- ◯ to prepare for a new career
- ◯ to renew her outdated credentials

2. What are Grace's top priorities at the moment?
- ◯ parental responsibilities and solid educational credentials
- ◯ industry-recognized certification and higher income
- ◯ marketing career success and popularity at work
- ◯ cost-effective programs and financial stability

3. How did Grace likely create her short list?
- ◯ by attending a class at each school
- ◯ by doing a lot of online research
- ◯ by speaking to recent graduates
- ◯ by getting advice from her boss

4. Why is the community college taken off the list?
- ◯ Its tuition fees are too expensive.
- ◯ Its relative standing is not yet known.
- ◯ Its timetable is unsuitable.
- ◯ Its certificates are of lower value.

5. What is Grace willing to pay more for?
- ◯ a quality team of highly experienced educators
- ◯ a program that guarantees employment upon completion
- ◯ a course schedule that fits with her personal life
- ◯ a curriculum based on marketing industry consultation

6. Why might the private marketing school be a risky choice?
- ◯ The cost of tuition is quite high.
- ◯ The school has not opened yet.
- ◯ Its curriculum may be too traditional.
- ◯ Its reputation is not yet established.

PART 5

7. What does Grace's husband think about the university course?

- ◯ It's the most suitable option.
- ◯ It's the wrong program for her.
- ◯ It's as good as the college course.
- ◯ It's scheduled at inconvenient times.

8. Why is Grace discussing program options with her friends?

- ◯ Her husband's advice was not very helpful.
- ◯ They also work in the marketing industry.
- ◯ She wants other outlooks on the programs.
- ◯ They have taken adult education programs.

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. The public transit problem is a result of _____

- ◯ mistakes by the transit planner.
- ◯ a decrease in functioning buses.
- ◯ a big rise in transit ridership.
- ◯ the city's small transit budget.

2. Commuter Thomas Findley is upset because his bus _____

- ◯ now takes a longer route.
- ◯ is often too full to get on.
- ◯ runs less frequently.
- ◯ gets stuck in traffic jams.

3. Transit planner Rita Cummings believes _____

- ◯ an underground system is a long-term solution.
- ◯ increasing bus routes would improve efficiency.
- ◯ building a subway system is not worth the cost.
- ◯ large buses are more practical than subways.

4. City councillor Scott Dresden would agree that _____

- ◯ the situation can be fixed with larger buses.
- ◯ an environmental choice might be the cheapest.
- ◯ subways are a good choice for smaller urban areas.
- ◯ purchasing modern buses is a short-term solution.

5. All solutions proposed are concerned with _____

- ◯ reducing the number of buses.
- ◯ limiting environmental impact.
- ◯ keeping costs to a minimum.
- ◯ carrying more passengers.

6. The city council will probably _____

- ◯ implement a commuter bus service.
- ◯ hire a subway system planner.
- ◯ initiate a transportation study.
- ◯ raise taxes for transit changes.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	a local bus
Question 2	She rarely travels on public transit.
Question 3	purchase tickets
Question 4	She looks young.
Question 5	
Question 6	give the woman the correct tickets
Question 7	She is buying something else.
Question 8	a fabric bag

PART 2	
Question 1	He and his family enjoy attending the events.
Question 2	They take place when it is too hot.
Question 3	watching the entertainment
Question 4	He thinks she should take her kids to the Canada Day events.
Question 5	She spends the day by the water.

PART 3	
Question 1	Devo is not learning math very quickly.
Question 2	once a week
Question 3	to request a lower price for them
Question 4	to improve Devo's math homework habits
Question 5	Devo's father
Question 6	give Devo a reward chart

PART 4	
Question 1	design.
Question 2	obtained a university degree.
Question 3	unsure of her plans for the future.
Question 4	wants Ms. Moretti to leave.
Question 5	person who built a unique residence.

PART 5	
Question 1	to study her current profession
Question 2	parental responsibilities and solid educational credentials
Question 3	by doing a lot of online research
Question 4	Its timetable is unsuitable.
Question 5	a quality team of highly experienced educators
Question 6	Its reputation is not yet established.
Question 7	It's the most suitable option.
Question 8	She wants other outlooks on the programs.

PART 6	
Question 1	a big rise in transit ridership.
Question 2	is often too full to get on.
Question 3	an underground system is a long-term solution.
Question 4	the situation can be fixed with larger buses.
Question 5	carrying more passengers.
Question 6	initiate a transportation study.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between a customer and a cashier. They are at a convenience store.

Section 1:

MAN: Will that be all today?

WOMAN: Yes, that's it, thanks. Actually, do you sell transit tickets?

MAN: Sure. Do you need them for local transit or the Rapid System?

WOMAN: I'm not sure . . . I live here, but I always drive. My car is in the shop today, though.

MAN: Well, Rapid System tickets are only good on commuter trains and buses. Those are the ones that travel to more distant communities, like Terryville just outside of town.

WOMAN: Well, I'm taking the bus to visit a friend who lives downtown. So I suppose that's local.

MAN: That's right. How many tickets would you like? We sell them in strips of 10 or 20.

WOMAN: I can't buy single tickets? I only need two!

MAN: Sorry. You can buy single tickets at the station but only multiples here. That'll be $26.00 for 10, plus your other items.

WOMAN: Well, okay then . . . if that's the only way you sell them . . .

Now answer questions 1-3.

1. What type of transit does the woman plan to take?
2. What is true about the woman?
3. What will the woman probably do next?

Section 2:

WOMAN: Hi. I was just here a few minutes ago. I took a look at those transit tickets when I left the store, and they have an "S" on them. Doesn't that mean they are for seniors?

MAN: Actually, the transit company issues the same tickets for both seniors and students to use. The "S" stands for both.

WOMAN: Oh. The thing is, I don't actually fit into either of those categories.

MAN: I'm so sorry! You have a backpack on, and you look like a lot of the university students who shop here.

WOMAN: A lot of people tell me that! I just have this because I'm bringing a few novels over to lend to my friend. We can never agree on what music is best, but we both like the same authors.

MAN: I see. Well, it's easy enough to exchange the tickets. Unfortunately, I'll have to charge you an extra $4.00. I'm very sorry!

WOMAN: I understand. And do you know where I can catch the #53 bus?

MAN: Sure. When you leave the store, make a right. The stop is right there on Division St. You can't miss it.

Now answer questions 4-6.

4. What does the man believe about the woman?
5. What does the woman say she is bringing for her friend?
6. What does the man suggest he will do?

Transcripts

Section 3:

MAN: Hello! Hey, you look familiar! Would you like a plastic bag for the loaf of bread?

WOMAN: No, I've got a reusable cloth one with me. You remember me? I was here last week.

MAN: Yes, the customer with the school bag who I thought was a student! Did you find the bus stop?

WOMAN: Yes, thank you! Your directions were very helpful, and the local tickets worked out fine. Though, with the traffic, it sure took a long time to get there from here!

MAN: I know what you mean. I take the bus downtown sometimes, too, and it always feels like it's rush hour!

Now answer questions 7-8.

7. Why does the woman return to the store?
8. What did the woman bring with her into the store?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a conversation between two parents about a special holiday.

MAN: Hi, Janice. Are you waiting for your daughter? For some reason the teacher always keeps the class late on Thursdays, doesn't she?

WOMAN: Yeah, I don't know why. Your daughter Maria's in the same class, right? Maybe the class is planning a surprise closing event for the parents!

MAN: Could be! Hey, talking about events, are you taking your kids to the Canada Day celebrations next week?

WOMAN: We aren't planning on it. July 1 is usually too hot, so we prefer to spend the day at the beach. We watch the fireworks in the evening, though.

MAN: You can go to the beach any day! The Canada Day events are special, and just once a year. Our kids love everything about it, especially the parade, so we go every year.

WOMAN: Really? Every year? Doesn't it get boring?

MAN: It's different every year. There are beautiful floats; you know, those decorated platforms that make up much of the parade. Last year there was a cool one with kids from the elementary school dressed up as movie characters.

WOMAN: What do they do to make the event especially Canadian?

MAN: Well, there are lots of red and white costumes to represent the colours of the flag. There's usually a Canadian military band, and the Royal Canadian Mounted Police on their horses. It's awesome!

WOMAN: Isn't it hot and crowded, though? And parking downtown must be a nightmare!

MAN: Yeah, but everyone's having fun, especially the kids. There's some free parking if you go early. Oh, and another great part is the food stalls at the football field where you can get delicious food at great prices. Plus, there are lots of kids' activities like bouncy castles and ring toss, not to mention clowns and jugglers everywhere.

WOMAN: Your enthusiasm is contagious! I'll talk about it with my husband and the kids, and check out the event schedule on the city's website.

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. Why does the man talk about Canada Day celebrations?
2. What is the woman's opinion of Canada Day celebrations?
3. What part of the Canada Day celebrations does the man most enjoy?
4. Why does the man mention so many kids' activities to the woman?
5. How does the woman usually spend Canada Day?

PART 3

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation where a man gets information about his son.

MAN: Excuse me, Priya? I'd like to speak with you about Devo's progress. I know you've been tutoring him for a few weeks now, but he's still doing poorly in math at school. He failed another test this week.

WOMAN: Yes, I'm afraid he's missed more than we thought. It may take until the end of the year for him to catch up.

MAN: Oh. That's discouraging news. Do you have any ideas about how we can move things along more quickly?

WOMAN: Sure. How about increasing his number of sessions? I could schedule him for twice a week, for example. Or even three times.

MAN: Well, that will be much more expensive, won't it?

WOMAN: We usually give a discount to families that register for multiple sessions. I'll talk to my manager.

MAN: That would be great, thanks. I was also concerned about Devo not doing all of the homework you assign. I'm sure you must have noticed.

WOMAN: Yes, that was the next point I was going to mention. I have a new technique I'd like to try with him. I've read that it is useful for developing stronger work habits.

MAN: Sure, anything! How will it work?

WOMAN: Well, first, I'll do part of his homework with him during our session. Then I'd like you to do the next part of his homework with him at home. Finally, he can do the last part by himself. Eventually, we can decrease the amount you and I do with him until he is doing all of it on his own.

MAN: Thanks, Priya. That sounds like a good place to start. It's just that, I hate to say this, but he thinks the exercise sheets you have him working on are a little . . . boring.

WOMAN: Well, we can use games or songs to help learn science or language, but math is something that just takes self-discipline. One thing that sometimes helps kids is a reward chart. You know, where he gets a sticker to put on the chart each time he does his homework?

MAN: I like that idea. Thanks for your help, Priya.

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. What is the man mainly concerned about?
2. How often does Devo receive tutoring right now?
3. Why does the woman say she will talk to her manager?
4. What is the purpose of the new homework strategy?
5. Which of the following is part of the new homework strategy?
6. What will the woman most likely do next?

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news item about a houseboat.

A new houseboat in Clearwater Harbour has been attracting the attention of tourists and locals. The architect and creator of the vessel, Antonia Moretti, appropriately refers to it as the "floating rectangle," and people who have seen it describe it as a shipping container on skis. It has taken Ms. Moretti two years to plan and build the houseboat, which is now moored in one of the most coveted areas of the city, surrounded by luxury apartments.

Building her houseboat allowed the 24-year-old graduate to apply her skills in marine architecture, a field she had been studying in both London, England and Shanghai, China. Although her degree can lead to jobs around the world that require this specialized skillset, she says her future goals are still vague. Ms. Moretti can often be seen fishing from the deck of her houseboat or chatting with enchanted passersby.

Not everyone is enamoured by the harbour's new addition, though. Mike MacDonald, a resident of a nearby apartment building, recently informed Ms. Moretti that she was ruining his view. She simply replied that it was a good view to share.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a conversation between three friends, one woman and two men. They are in a coffee shop discussing different educational options.

Luke: So, Grace, what do you intend to study?

Grace: Marketing. I think that I need a formal education to supplement my hands-on experience. My work doesn't know yet, but I think they'll be supportive. I have three programs on my shortlist, but I'm still having trouble deciding which one.

Josh: Well, we're here to help. What are your options?

Grace: Well, I'm deciding between an evening program at the community college, a full-time program at a private marketing school, or a weekend program at the university. According to their websites, all of them offer certificates upon completion, but they differ in cost and schedule.

Josh: Where to start?

Grace: Well, as you know . . . I'm not an ordinary student. I've been out of school for many years, I have a family, and I work part-time as a Marketing Assistant.

Luke: Well, those all sound like advantages to me; I mean, you already have tons of experience in the field, and you'll be way more motivated as a student.

Grace: Yes, but I need a program that will fit my busy schedule and offer results.

Josh: From what I know, evening class are very popular with busy adult learners.

Grace: Right; but the more I think about it, the more I realize I'm not willing to give up my evening family time for anything.

Josh: Well, that's one thing off the list. How concerned are you about tuition, Grace?

Grace: Good question. I am not particularly rich, but I think I would rather pay more for an excellent education than save a little money for little in return.

Luke: Well, what do you know about the private marketing school you mentioned? It's a full-time program, right?

Grace: Yes. The curriculum looks great. It has all the latest trends: digital marketing, online advertising . . . The only thing is, it's basically brand new—it only opened about six months ago.

Josh: Hmm. Yeah, you may want to wait and see how their first graduates are doing after they finish next year.

Luke: . . . or you could just take weekend classes at the university now.

Grace: Yeah, I wish I could sit in on a class. It's a well-respected program that's been offered for over a decade, it's widely recognized in the industry . . . On the flip side, it's kinda pricey.

Luke: But didn't you say you were ready to invest in your future?

Grace: I did. I think I'm leaning towards the university. It works well with Saturday and Sunday being good for my family. And my husband says I can't go wrong with that one. I think I've made my decision!

Josh: We are so proud of you Grace!

Luke: Good luck!

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear an announcer report on different viewpoints about public transit.

On the agenda for yesterday's city council meeting was yet another discussion of the public transit dilemma. Over the past 15 years, this city has experienced a significant growth in population, a trend expected to continue well into the future. As a result of this growth, the public transit system, designed with a much smaller population in mind, has been operating beyond its capacity.

As an example, Thomas Findley commutes from Glenfield to downtown on a daily basis. While a year ago it took him thirty-five minutes to arrive at work by bus, the timeframe today is more in the realm of one hour and thirty-five minutes. For Findley, this is unacceptable. He contends that the delays stem from an increase in public transit users without a corresponding increase in the number of buses. The result: buses are often full to capacity and riders must wait long periods before one with space will stop for more passengers. As a solution, Findley has suggested doubling the number of buses in operation.

However, transit planner Rita Cummings argues that this would only be a temporary fix. She insists that increasing the number of buses would lead to significantly more traffic, something which, in the long run, could cause both greater delays as well as an increase in air pollution. Instead, Cummings has proposed the construction of a subway system. Since subways run underground, a large number of commuters can be moved without a corresponding increase in traffic. Consequently, Cummings feels that for growing cities, a subway system is almost always the most efficient and environmentally sound choice. She noted that subways in Toronto and Montreal have successfully fulfilled their roles for decades, each now carrying more than a million passengers every day.

In contrast, while city councillor Scott Dresden agrees a subway is a nice idea, he questions whether the need truly justifies the expense. According to Dresden, the cost of developing a subway system could easily run into the billions. Although the city's population is growing, it is unlikely to ever reach the numbers to warrant such an expense. As an alternative, Dresden has suggested the purchase of modern, efficiently designed buses which have the capacity to carry double the number of passengers. This option, Dresden asserts, would lead to neither an increase in traffic nor a breaking of the bank. In the days to come, council will need to find a solution, be it subway, bigger buses, or maintaining the status quo. It's election year, so it's anyone's guess what council will do to curry favour.